

IP Protection Roadmap — NeuralQuant / Satyam Das

A student founder in Australia (UTS Sydney), building a platform incorporated or intended for India + global use. This guide covers the honest truth about software patents, what actually protects you, and exactly what to do first — **in order of urgency and cost**.

⚠ **Most urgent fact:** If you have publicly disclosed the platform (GitHub is public, live on Vercel, shared on social media), you have a **12-month grace period from the earliest public disclosure date** to file a provisional patent before that disclosure can be used against you. The clock is already running. This is not an excuse to delay — it is the deadline.

The honest truth about patents for AI software

Can you patent NeuralQuant?

Yes — but it's nuanced. Pure software/algorithms are not patentable in India (Section 3(k), Patents Act 1970) or Australia. But NeuralQuant is not "pure software." It is a system that produces a measurable technical effect — regime-shifted quant scoring with demonstrable market alpha. That framing is exactly what the Indian CRI Guidelines 2025 (effective July 29, 2025) say qualifies. The claim must be for the technical system, not the algorithm in isolation.

What is actually more protective than a patent?

For a student with limited capital, a patent is not your primary protection. Your real protection is:

- (1) **copyright on source code** — automatic, free, exists right now;
- (2) trade secret on the PARA-DEBATE architecture;
- (3) first-mover lead;
- (4) network effects from data;
- (5) a patent filing that creates "patent pending" status and deters copycats. The patent is a signal and a deterrent, not a wall.

UTS University Ownership Risk — As NeuralQuant was developed using **Zero university resources, equipment, or supervision and also not submitted as part of any UTS coursework or thesis - UTS have no claim.**

You own 100% of the IP. (do this immediately): Write and sign a one-page "Independent Development Declaration" and store it safely. This takes 20 minutes and is your permanent defence against any future ownership challenge — from UTS, a co-founder, an early collaborator, or anyone else. *Template below, towards the end of this document.*

How to store this declaration: (1) Sign a physical copy, photograph it, email it to yourself — the email timestamp is **legally significant**. (2) Upload to Google Drive or Notion with automatic version timestamping. (3) Keep the physical signed copy. (4) Optionally, get it notarised by an Indian notary — costs ₹100–₹200 and makes it court-admissible.

If there's any grey area @UTS : *You should proactively speak to UTS Startups. Many universities will sign an IP waiver for student-initiated commercial projects, especially when the student is the sole developer. Getting a formal waiver in writing is far safer than assuming.*

The 5-layer IP protection stack — what to do, in order

1. Copyright — automatic, do it today, costs nothing

Copyright in source code is automatic in both India and Australia from the moment of creation. You already own copyright on every line of NeuralQuant.

Add copyright notice to GitHub repo README and codebase header files: "© 2024–2026 Satyam Das. All rights reserved. Proprietary and confidential." Change repo visibility to private or add a PROPRIETARY LICENSE file.

Currently the repo has no license, which creates ambiguity. A missing license means legally "all rights reserved" but a clear statement closes any argument.

Cost: ₹0 / \$0 — Do this today, takes 10 minutes.

2. Provisional Patent (India) — secure your priority date NOW

A provisional patent application (PPA) with the Indian Patent Office secures your priority date immediately. It does not need to be perfect — it just needs to describe the invention sufficiently. You then have 12 months to file the full complete specification with claims. **Filing as a "natural person" (individual) gets you an 80% fee concession.** The PARA-DEBATE 7-agent system + 5-factor quant engine + India-US dual market architecture is the patentable system. Frame it as: "A computer-implemented system for generating regime-adaptive multi-factor equity research signals using a multi-agent adversarial debate framework." That's a technical system with measurable technical effect — **it passes the CRI 2025 test.**

Government fee (individual): ₹1,600 (~\$20). With a patent agent for drafting: ₹15,000–₹25,000 total (~\$180–\$300). This is the single most important spend.

3. Trade Secret protection — document the architecture formally

The PARA-DEBATE debate architecture, the specific agent roles and synthesis logic, the factor weighting model, and the regime detection heuristics are all trade secrets. To protect them:

- Make the GitHub repo private or remove the core agent logic from public view — keep only the frontend/UI public.
- Create a formal internal technical document describing the full architecture, dated and signed. Store it on a timestamped platform (Notion with version history, or email to yourself via Gmail — creates a date record).
- Every collaborator, contractor, or investor who sees the system should sign an NDA before access.

Cost: ₹0. A basic NDA template is free. This takes 2–3 hours.

4. Trademark — protect the brand name "NeuralQuant" and "PARA-DEBATE"

Both "NeuralQuant" and "PARA-DEBATE™" (already used on the landing page) should be registered as trademarks in India under Class 42 (Software/SaaS/Technology Services). This prevents any competitor from using these names. **As an individual, the filing fee is ₹4,500 per mark per class via the Indian Trademark Registry (e-filing).** This is separate from a patent and far simpler to obtain. Trademark registration in India typically takes 18–24 months but you get "TM" status (and legal protection) from the day of filing.

Government fee: ₹4,500 per mark (~\$55). Two marks (NeuralQuant + PARA-DEBATE) = ₹9,000 (~\$110). No agent needed — file directly at ipindia.gov.in.

5. PCT / International Patent — after the India provisional is filed

Once the India provisional is filed, You will have 12 months to file a PCT (Patent Cooperation Treaty) application which covers 150+ countries including USA, Australia, EU, UK, Singapore in a single application. This delays individual national filing decisions for up to 30 months while preserving the India priority date. This is the path to a US patent. **File the PCT only after the complete India specification is ready and ideally after raising pre-seed funding** — the cost is significant but manageable with investor capital.

PCT filing (individual): ~\$1,400–\$2,200 USD + attorney fees. Do this in Year 2 once funded.

Cost summary — what you actually needs to spend right now:

Sl.no.	Action	Timeline	Gov. fee (individual)	With agent	Priority
1	Copyright notice + private repo	Today	₹ 0	₹ 0	Do today
2	Provisional patent — IPO (India)	Within 30 days	₹ 1,600	₹15,000–₹25,000	Urgent
3	Trademark: "NeuralQuant"	Within 60 days	₹ 4,500	₹ 0	High
4	Trademark: "PARA-DEBATE"	Within 60 days	₹ 4,500	₹ 0	High
5	NDA template (for investors/ partners)	Before any investor meeting	₹ 0	₹ 0	High
6	Complete patent specification (India)	Within 12 months of provisional	₹ 1,600	₹30,000–₹50,000	Planned
7	PCT international filing	Year 2 — post-funding	~₹1.2L	₹2.5L–₹4L	Post-seed
8	Total immediate spend (Steps 1–4)	Next 60 days	₹ 10,600	₹ 25,000	

What to say to investors about IP protection

Investor-ready answer once the above is done:

"NeuralQuant's core system — including the PARA-DEBATE multi-agent architecture and regime-adaptive quant scoring engine — is protected by a provisional patent application filed with the Indian Patent Office (Application No. XXXX, filed [date]), with a PCT international filing planned for Q4 2026. The NeuralQuant and PARA-DEBATE trademarks are registered in India. All source code is proprietary copyright of Satyam Das. The India + US dual-market signal architecture represents 18+ months of development and constitutes a meaningful technical lead over any potential competitor."

Three things that protect NeuralQuant more than any patent

Speed of execution

Get to 5,000 paying users before anyone else builds this. Market penetration is the best moat. A patent takes 5–7 years to grant. Users are immediate.

Proprietary data & feedback loops

Every user query, every model prediction vs actual return — this data trains better models over time. Competitors can copy the architecture but not the data history.

India-specific signal expertise

NSE Bhavcopy parsing, delivery_pct signal, India VIX heuristics — this institutional knowledge lives in Your head and codebase. It takes years to replicate, not months.

NOTE: Look for agents registered with the Indian Patent Office (search at ipindia.gov.in/patent-agents). For budget-conscious filings, **LexOrbis**, **K&S Partners**, or **Inttl Advocare** (all Delhi/Bangalore based) have handled student and startup AI patent filings. Many offer free first consultations.

What this clean ownership means for the investor pitch

Cap table is 100% Yours

No university equity claim, no hidden co-founder, no institutional override. Every share issued in the company goes to Satyam first. This is the cleanest pre-investment cap table possible. Investors love this — no legacy complications to clean up at due diligence.

IP assignment to company is straightforward

When you incorporate a company (India Pvt Ltd or Singapore/Delaware for funding purposes), you simply assign all NeuralQuant IP to the company via a one-page IP Assignment Agreement. Since you own it 100%, no one else needs to sign off. This just takes one document.

Patent filing is unambiguous

The provisional patent application at IPO is filed in the name: "Satyam Das, Indian national, residing at [address]." No joint inventors, no assignee complications. If UTS ever raised a claim later (extremely unlikely given clean development), the declaration above is the evidence.

No "university carve-out" needed in term sheet

Some Indian/Australian VCs ask for a warranty that "the company owns all IP and no third party (including any university) has a claim." You can give that warranty cleanly and without qualification. This removes a standard friction point in early-stage term sheet negotiations.

Declaration of Independent Development & Sole Ownership

I, **Satyam Das**, residing at **483 Wattle St, Ultimo NSW 2007, Sydney, Australia**, hereby declare as follows:

1. Sole Authorship

I am the sole creator, developer, and inventor of the software platform known as **NeuralQuant**, including its multi-agent analysis system (PARA-DEBATE), five-factor quantitative scoring engine, India-US dual market data architecture, and all associated frontend, backend, and data pipeline code.

2. Independent Development

NeuralQuant was developed entirely independently. No resources, equipment, compute infrastructure, funding, supervision, or intellectual contribution from the University of Technology Sydney (UTS) or any other institution were used in its creation. The platform was not developed as part of any coursework, thesis, research project, or funded programme.

3. Personal Resources

Development was conducted entirely on personally owned hardware, using personally funded cloud services (including but not limited to: Vercel, Supabase, Render, Anthropic API), and personal funds. No institutional licences, lab access, or grants were used.

4. Original Work

The invention is original. All third-party libraries and APIs used are publicly available under open-source or commercial licences. The NeuralQuant system architecture, PARA-DEBATE debate framework, and quant scoring methodology are my own original intellectual work.

5. Ownership

I am the sole and exclusive owner of all intellectual property rights in NeuralQuant, including copyright, trade secrets, and any patent rights arising from the invention.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Full name: Satyam Das

Witnessed by: _____ Date: _____

Full name: _____